ADV 115

STRATEGIES FOR SPEAKING UP AND TAKING ACTION

Speaking up is not just complaining, it is communicating a problem clearly, respectfully, and strategically to the appropriate authority with the aim of seeking a solution.

STEPS IN SPEAKING UP AND TAKING ACTION:

1. By defining the issue clearly.
2. Gather facts and complaints.
3. Identify the appropriate authority to lay your complaints to.
4. Use respectful and professional language.
5. Build collective support.
6. Follow due process and avoid acting impulsively.
7. Be persistent and follow up the progress of the complaints.

ARCHITECTURE OF A FORMAL PETITION

Every petition is a complaint but not every complaint is a petition.

Why? A petition is WRITTEN.

A petition is a formal written complaint or request submitted to an authority asking for an intervention, investigation, or solution to a problem.

ARCHITECTURE OF A FORMAL PETITION (PARTS OF A PETITION):

1. Headings and dates
2. Recipient's name and office
3. The salutation bearing a polite greeting
4. The subject line (It should be short but precise and easy to understand)
5. Introduction of the petitioners
6. Statement of facts (What? When? Where? Who?) *It should be based on facts, not personal emotions.*
7. Evidence summary
8. Legal or constitutional basis
9. Reliefs sought: State the action you want the authority to take or the solution to proffer.
10. Conclusion and prayer
11. Signature and contact information
12. Attachments (Any appropriate form of [evidence])

CHARACTERISTICS OF A GOOD PETITION:

- It should be clear and concise.
- It should be factual and truthful.
- Be respectful in tone.
- It should be well organized.
- It should be supported by evidence.
- State the specific remedies requested.

EVIDENCE GATHERING & DOCUMENTATION OF INCIDENCE

An evidence is any fact, document, object, or information used to prove that an event actually occurred.

In advocacy and petitioning, evidence is crucial

IMPORTANCE OF EVIDENCE:

- It supports one's claims.
- It makes petitions more credible.
- It helps authorities investigate.
- It prevents false accusations.
- It increases the chances of getting justice.

TYPES OF EVIDENCE:

1. **Documentary evidence:** e.g., receipts, letters, memo, course registration forms, etc. (They are written or printed materials).
2. **Electronic evidence:** Information stored electronically, e.g., chats, SMS message, voice note, screenshots.
3. Photographs and videos
4. Witness statement
5. Audio recordings
6. Financial records

PRINCIPLES OF EFFECTIVE DOCUMENTATION:

1. Record dates and time.
2. Preserve original evidence.
3. Arrange evidence chronologically.
4. Avoid alterations.
5. Back-up electronic files.
6. Obtain corroboration.
7. Support your evidence with additional evidence.

PROCEDURES FOR FILING PETITION IN SUG & OTHER UNIVERSITY MANAGEMENT

1. Internal resolution.
2. Draft the petition.
3. Attach supporting documents.
4. Submit to the appropriate office.
5. Obtain acknowledgement, example: Official stamp, signature.
6. Follow up.
7. Escalate if necessary.

ETHICAL CONSIDERATIONS IN ADVOCACY AND PETITIONING

Ethics are moral principles that guide our behaviour.

CONSEQUENCES OF UNETHICAL CONDUCT:

1. Defamation
2. Loss of credibility
3. Disciplinary action
4. Miscarriage of justice

ETHICAL BEHAVIOURS:

1. Truthfulness
2. Confidentiality
3. Fairness
4. Respect for due process
5. Avoid malicious accusations
6. Responsible communication (be factual)
7. Never lie

LDR 101

LEADERSHIP STRATEGIES FOR EFFECTIVE GRASSROOT MOBILIZATION

Theme: How leaders make ordinary people to accomplish extra ordinary things

MOBILIZE

M – Make Your Vision Clear

O – Own the Mission

B – Build Relationships

I – Inspire Action

A plan without action is a plantain chips

L – Listen Before Leading

I – Influence Through Service

Z – Zero Excuses

E – Evaluate and Evolve

Leadership is not the ability to stand in front of people but to move people to a purpose they were not able to reach.

JCY 111

ETHYMOLOGY AND RANKS OF THE JUDICIARY

COURT HIERARCHY

Court hierarchy refers to the arrangement of courts according to their authority and jurisdiction, from the highest to the lowest.

1. Supreme Court of Nigeria
2. Court of Appeal
3. High Courts (Federal and State)
4. National Industrial Court of Nigeria
5. Magistrate Courts
6. Customary and Sharia Courts

ASSIGNMENT

Question: How many federal high courts are in Nigeria?